THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 7 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · MEDIUM LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 5: **Cities and States: The Second Urbanisation** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Medium level: multi-step questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Why did the Ganga plains support many mahajanapadas? 1

(a) desert climate **(b)** no people

(c) fertile land, iron and trade routes **(d)** no rivers

2. Why was Pataliputra's location good? 1

(a) in a forest **(b)** in a mountain

(c) in a desert **(d)** at the meeting of rivers

3. Why are the early Buddhist and Jain teachers important in this period? 1

(a) they ruled

(b) they fought

(c) they traded

(d) they questioned rituals and spread new ideas

4. Why was iron more useful than bronze for farming? 1

(a) it was costlier

(b) it was softer

(c) it was rarer

(d) it was stronger and more widely available

5. What does the varna-jati system reflect? 1

(a) equality

(b) no divisions

(c) one occupation

(d) division of society by occupation and birth

6. Why did guilds matter? 1

(a) they printed coins **(b)** they ruled states

(c) they organised crafts and trade **(d)** they made laws

7. Why did trade grow along with coins? 1

(a) standard money made exchange easier **(b)** barter ended trade

(c) coins were free **(d)** coins were rare

8. Why did occupations become hereditary over time? 1

(a) skills passed through families **(b)** by elections

(c) by law only **(d)** by chance

9. What is meant by a confederation like Vajji? 1

(a) a union of clans or states **(b)** single kingdom
(c) trade guild **(d)** foreign state

10. Why were punch-marked coins important to historians? 1

(a) they are food **(b)** they are art only
(c) they are modern **(d)** they show trade and authority of rulers

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why did iron tools increase farming? 2

12. What did sabha and samiti do? 2

13. What is the importance of archaeology? 2

14. Why were coins useful in trade? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Explain the link between iron, agriculture and cities. 3

16. Explain how social divisions developed. 3

17. Describe the capitals of the mahajanapadas. 3

OR

Explain how coins differed from barter. 3

18. Explain how religion changed in the period. 3

OR

Explain the decline of Harappan cities and the later rise of cities. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Explain the process of the Second Urbanisation and its causes. 5

OR

Explain the sources that help us study the cities of the period. 5

20. Compare monarchies and republics in the mahajanapada period. 5

OR

Describe the fortified cities and the life within them. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND